Choose the good way

Starter lesson 01 · Psalm 1:1–2 · 40 minutes

Read from your Bible: Psalm 1:1–2 in NIV or Good News Bible (GNB).

Lesson summary, not a Bible quotation: God's teaching helps us consider the advice we follow and the choices we make. We can enjoy learning his ways.

Today's learning goal

Identify the contrast in Psalm 1:1–2, evaluate peer influence and connect thoughtful reflection on Scripture with an everyday decision.

Before the children arrive

Have a Bible, crayons or pencils and these pages ready. Cut the cards on page 5. No internet or special equipment is needed.

A lesson you can lead

5 min **Connect.** Ask: When can advice feel popular but still be unhelpful? Avoid naming classmates.

8 min **Read closely.** Read Psalm 1:1–2 in NIV or GNB. Compare what the person avoids in verse 1 with what the person enjoys in verse 2.

12 min **Reason.** Work through page 3. Require a reason and a respectful response, not just a correct label.

8 min **Create.** Use page 4 to map a decision and the sources of advice you will consider.

7 min **Practise.** Role play an action card, write a weekly intention and pray.

Keep the message caring

Talk about helpful or harmful actions, not "good children" and "bad children". Welcome questions. Explain that we can apologise, ask for help and try again. This passage is not a promise that life will always be easy.

A little time together

A family conversation · 15 minutes · A Bible and a willing grownup

Read, talk and try

4 min Read both verses. Each person names one observation without rushing to an application.

7 min Discuss one dilemma from page 3. Consider who is affected and what a respectful response might sound like.

4 min Write one specific intention. Pray, then revisit it later in the week.

Questions with room for different answers

What is the contrast between the two verses?

Grownup guidance: Verse 1 describes influences and conduct to avoid; verse 2 describes delighting in and reflecting on God’s teaching.

Does refusing harmful advice require rejecting a person?

Grownup guidance: No. You can disagree with an action, remain respectful and seek help. Do not label children as bad people.

One practice for the week

Pause before following advice this week. Ask: Is it true? Is it kind? What does Scripture help me notice? Who could help me think?

A prayer to say together

God, help me enjoy your Word and think carefully about it. Give me courage to question harmful advice, humility to receive help and kindness towards people who disagree. Amen.

Our family’s idea

What will we try, and when?

Pause. Think. Choose.

Name: _____ Date: _____

For each dilemma, identify the influence, choose a response and explain your reasoning. Different thoughtful answers are welcome.

1. The group chat

Friends share an embarrassing photo of a classmate. They say forwarding it proves you are loyal. What could you say or do while showing care for everyone involved?

2. The easy answer

A helpful friend offers their completed homework to copy. You want to finish quickly. How could you accept support without copying their work?

3. The popular claim

A video claims that people who follow God never have problems. What questions would you ask, and which trusted adult could help you examine that claim?

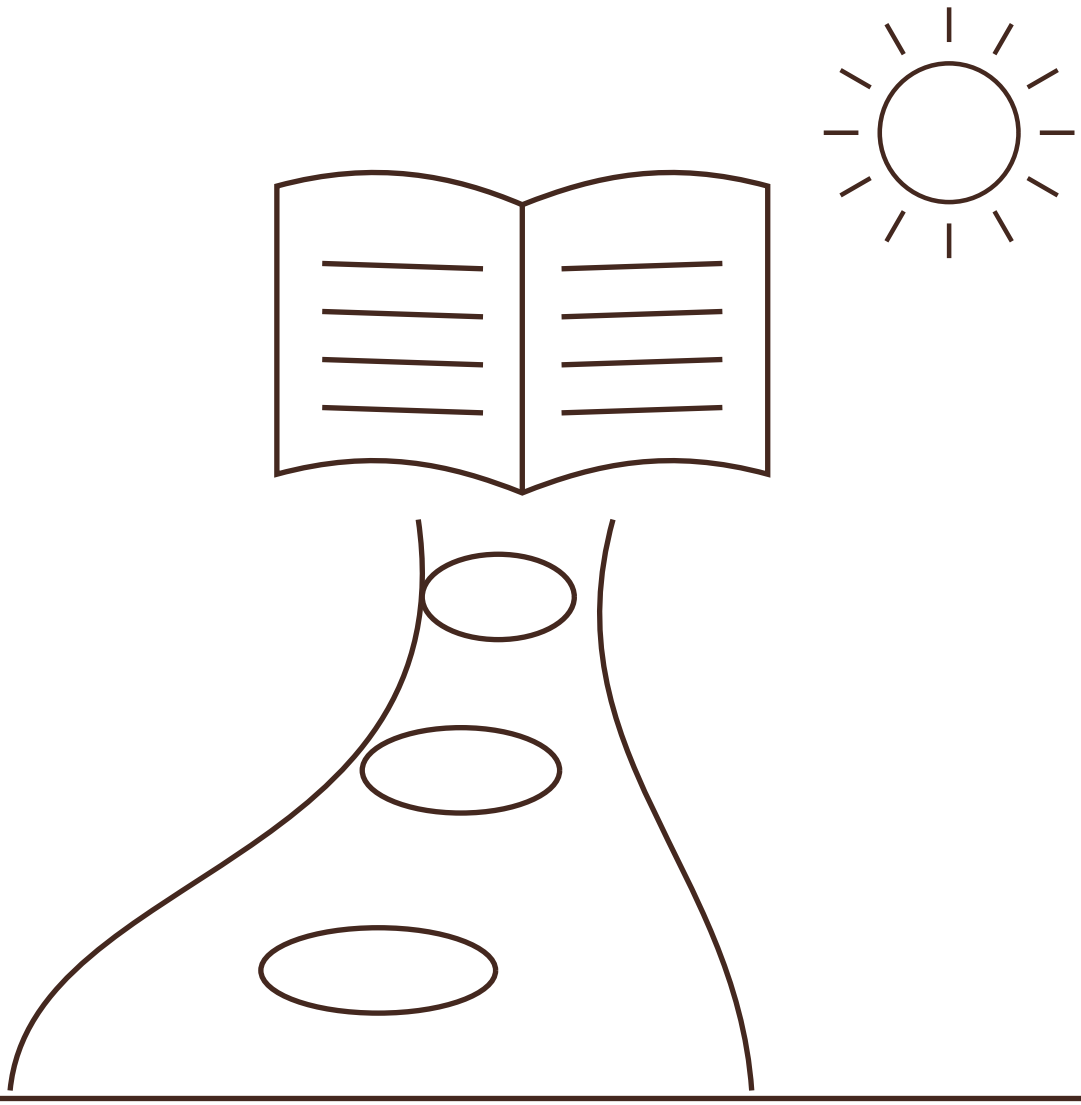
Connect: What does verse 2 add to the things avoided in verse 1?

Make your good way

Read Psalm 1:1–2 together before starting.

Use the scene as a decision map. On the path, write a real decision. Around the Bible, note helpful questions, Scripture ideas and trusted people to consult.

My ideas can go anywhere inside this frame.



My next helpful choice: _____

Grownup note: this drawing supports discussion. The path and sun are illustrations, not a picture described in verses 1–2.

Small choices, big care

Grownup: cut on the dotted lines. Pick a card, talk, then practise together.



SHARE

Someone wants a turn with your crayons. What could you do?



WELCOME

A child is playing alone. How could you invite them?



TELL THE TRUTH

You made a mistake. Who could you ask for help?



LISTEN

Someone gives you advice. What could you ask before acting?



ENCOURAGE

A friend is finding a task difficult. What could you say?



LEARN

Choose a time to enjoy a Bible passage with a grownup.

Older children: add a respectful sentence you could actually say. Younger children: let a grownup read and model an action.

Encourage the thinking

Suggested responses and a gentle check in

Page 3: answer guidance

1: Notice pressure to prove loyalty. Do not forward the photo; ask friends to stop, support the classmate and involve a trusted adult if needed. 2: Ask for an explanation or work alongside your friend while doing your own answers. 3: Question the claim, read the passage in context and ask a trusted adult; Psalm 1:1–2 does not say faithful people never have problems. Verse 2 adds a positive focus: delighting in and reflecting on God’s teaching. Accept other reasoned, caring responses.

Pages 4 and 5: notice effort

There is no single correct drawing or script. Praise careful thought, willingness to listen and a concrete act of care. Invite children to explain their picture or choice. Support children who prefer pointing, movement or a spoken answer.

A check in after the lesson

What did you notice in the Bible passage?

Which choice will you practise?

Who can help you when you are unsure?

Adapt without pressure

Read aloud as needed. Offer a spoken answer, a drawing or a gesture. Give extra time and a break. In mixed age groups, read together, then use the activity for each child’s stage. An older child can help a younger child without doing the activity for them.

Content note: All explanations and scenarios in this pack are original teaching material. They are not verbatim Scripture. Read Psalm 1:1–2 from a licensed NIV or GNB Bible. Starter pack prepared for review by The Bible Playroom team before use in a class.